

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 21

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Mike O'Neil of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Mike O'Neil, a gentleman who was essential to youth sports in the Nashville area for twenty-five years as a USA Hockey official; and

WHEREAS, Mr. O'Neil was ubiquitous at every level of hockey in Nashville; he loved playing and coaching the sport, but it is his work as an on-ice official for which he will be most remembered; and

WHEREAS, he earned certification as a USA Hockey referee when he moved to the Music City, his move coinciding with the Nashville Predators' inaugural season in the NHL; and

WHEREAS, Mr. O'Neil officiated numerous recreational and travel league, high school, and college club hockey games over the years; he eventually became certified as an off-ice official for the NHL and worked Predators' home games; and

WHEREAS, noted for his disarming smile, he continued to play hockey competitively and often participated in adult tournaments as a member of an all-O'Neil-family team; and

WHEREAS, when his health began to fail in 2020, Mike O'Neil continued to referee hockey matches during his medical treatment, and he was fortunate to officiate the game he loved until near the end of his purposeful and productive life; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of Mr. O'Neil's many enduring contributions both on and off the ice and his legacy in Nashville's hockey community, the Greater Nashville Area Scholastic Hockey League's all-star game trophy has been named in his honor; and

WHEREAS, Mike O'Neil gave selflessly of himself in support of hundreds of hockey players, helping them develop their skills at a crucial age, and his life should be properly commemorated; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Mike O'Neil, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable record of community service as a player, coach, and especially referee in Nashville's hockey leagues and his lifelong commitment to helping others.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and condolences to Mr. O'Neil's family and friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.